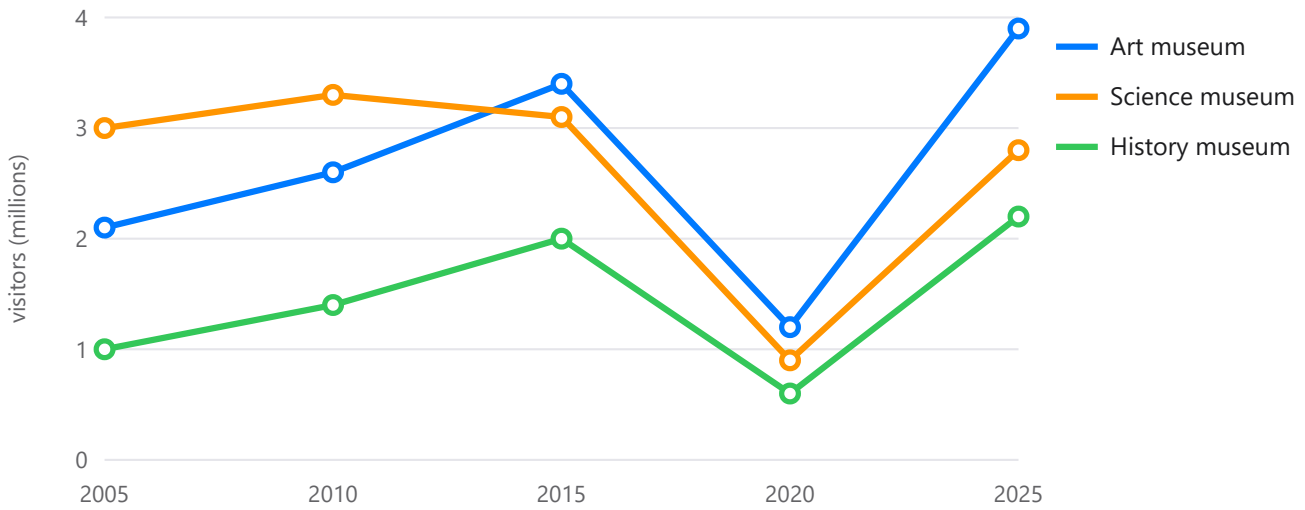
IELTS TURBO · WEEK 1 · SUN 1 NOV 2026 · TASK 1 · LINE GRAPH

Writing Task 1: a line graph

> **The line graph below shows the number of visitors to three museums in a European city between 2005 and 2025. Summarize the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.**

Visitors to three city museums, 2005–2025



Drawn for this lesson (the numbers are invented). For an official graph, use one from his collection of Task 1 reports.

20 minutes · at least 150 words · typed on the computer. Plan for 3 minutes, write for 15, check for 2.

Your plan

Introduction	One sentence: paraphrase the title (what, where, when, the unit). Never copy the question.
Overview	The two or three biggest things you see, with NO numbers: the general trend, the highest, any big change.
Body 1	The first part of the period (here 2005 to 2015), with numbers. Compare the lines; do not describe them one by one.
Body 2	The rest of the period (here 2020 to 2025): the big drop and the recovery, with numbers.

Model answer

Written for this lesson · 168 words · the highlighted phrases are in the vocabulary table.

The line graph compares the number of people who visited three museums in a European city between 2005 and 2025, measured in millions.

Overall, the three museums **followed a similar pattern** after 2015: visitor numbers **fell sharply** in 2020 and then recovered by 2025. The art museum **overtook** the science museum to become the most popular attraction, while the history museum remained the least visited throughout the period.

In 2005, the science museum was the most popular, with 3 million visitors, **compared with** 2.1 million for the art museum and just 1 million for the history museum. Over the next ten years, the art museum **saw a steady rise** to 3.4 million, **surpassing** the science museum, whose figures **remained relatively stable** at around 3 to 3.3 million. The history museum **doubled** its visitors to 2 million.

In 2020, numbers **plummeted** at all three museums, **hitting a low of** 1.2, 0.9 and 0.6 million **respectively**. By 2025, however, they had **rebounded**: the art museum **reached a peak of** 3.9 million, the history museum climbed to 2.2 million, and the science museum recovered to 2.8 million, **slightly below** its earlier level.

Before you hand it in

- ☐ The introduction paraphrases the title; it does not copy it.
- ☐ There is an overview with NO numbers (the main trend and the biggest change).
- ☐ The lines are compared, not described one after another.
- ☐ The key numbers are there, with years (in 2020, by 2025, between 2005 and 2015).
- ☐ Past tenses for finished years; 150 words or more (aim for 170 to 190).

Vocabulary from the model answer

PHRASE	MEANING	SIMILAR WORDS YOU CAN USE
followed a similar pattern	changed in the same way	*showed the same trend · moved in parallel*
fell sharply	went down fast and a lot	*dropped dramatically · declined steeply · a sharp fall*
overtook / surpassing	became higher than another line	*outstripped · exceeded · moved ahead of*
compared with	used to put two numbers side by side	*as opposed to · against · while*
saw a steady rise	went up slowly but all the time	*rose gradually · increased steadily · a gradual climb*
remained relatively stable	changed very little	*leveled off · stayed roughly the same · hovered around*
doubled	became two times bigger	*rose twofold · tripled (×3) · halved (÷2)*
plummeted	fell very fast and very far	*plunged · collapsed · dropped dramatically*
hitting a low of	reaching its lowest point	*bottoming out at · falling to a low of*
respectively	in the same order as the list before	*in that order*
rebounded	went back up after a fall	*recovered · picked up · bounced back*
reached a peak of	reached its highest point	*peaked at · hit a high of · topped out at*
slightly below	a little less than	*marginally lower than · just under · somewhat below*

The language of change: verb form and noun form

VERB FORM	NOUN FORM	WRITE IT LIKE THIS
rise / increase / climb	a rise / an increase	*rose sharply to 3.4 million · a sharp rise to 3.4 million*
fall / decrease / drop / decline	a fall / a drop / a decline	*fell slightly to 2.8 million · a slight fall to 2.8 million*
plummet / plunge	a plunge	*plummeted to 0.9 million · a dramatic plunge*
fluctuate	a fluctuation	*fluctuated between 3 and 3.3 million*
level off / stay stable	stability	*leveled off at around 3 million*
peak at	reach a peak of	*peaked at 3.9 million in 2025*
hit a low of	reach a low of	*hit a low of 0.6 million in 2020*

How big and how fast

BIG CHANGE	MEDIUM CHANGE	SMALL CHANGE
dramatically · sharply · significantly	considerably · markedly · steadily	*slightly · marginally · gradually*

Use it: write your own report on the same graph in 20 minutes. Use at least five phrases from these tables, and give an overview with no numbers.